

Word family: **like / likes / liked / liking / unlike / likely / unlikely / likelihood / likeness / alike**

Base word: like

Past tense: liked

Past participle: liked

Related forms / useful family members: liking, unlike, likely, unlikely, likelihood, likeness, alike

Useful expressions / extensions: be like, look like, sound like, feel like, like + noun, like doing, would like, nothing like, something like, more like, like-minded

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / preposition-like comparison word (比較用法) / conjunction-like informal use (非正式連接用法) / noun (名詞) / adjective-related family (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “She has a calm presence, and to me she is a bit **like** an old tree...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **like** means **similar to / resembling**.

The speaker is making a comparison between the grandmother and an old tree. The grandmother is not literally a tree; she resembles one metaphorically because she gives others:

* stability

* shade

* comfort

* a sense of calm and endurance

繁體中文： ** **表示某人或某事物與另一人 / 事物在某些方面相似；像.....一樣 / 有點像.....

**中文翻譯： **

> “To me she is a bit like an old tree.”

「對我來說，她有點**像**一棵老樹。」

Here:

be like + noun = 在某些特質、外觀、行為或感覺上與.....相似

1. **be like + person/thing (相似) — 像.....；和.....相似**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She is a bit **like** an old tree.”

「她有點**像**一棵老樹。」

Practice 2

> “He is very **like** his father.”

「他跟爸爸**很相似**。」

Practice 3

> “The building is **like** a castle.”

「這座建築**像**一座城堡。」

like = 表示兩個人 / 事物在某些特徵上相似，但不是完全相同

2. **look like** + person/thing (外表像) — 看起來像

A crucial comparison pattern.

Practice 4

> “She **looks like** her mother.”

「她**長得像**她媽媽。」

Practice 5

> “That cloud **looks like** a bird.”

「那朵雲**看起來像**一隻鳥。」

look like = 在外觀或視覺上與某人 / 某物相似

3. **sound like** + person/thing (聽起來像) — 聽起來像

Practice 6

> “You **sound like** your sister.”

「你的聲音**很像**你姐姐。」

Practice 7

> “That **sounds like** a good idea.”

「那**聽起來像**一個好主意。」

sound like = 根據聲音或聽到的內容，覺得與某人 / 某事相似或符合某種描述

4. **feel like + noun (感覺像) — 感覺像；彷彿是**

Practice 8

> “This room **feels like** home.”

「這個房間**感覺像家一樣**。」

Practice 9

> “It **felt like** a dream.”

「那**感覺像一場夢**。」

feel like + noun = 某種主觀感受令人聯想到某人 / 某物 / 某狀態

5. **feel like + -ing (想做.....) — 想；有心情做.....**

A completely different construction.

Practice 10

> “I **feel like going** for a walk.”

「我**想去散步**。」

Practice 11

> “Do you **feel like having** some tea?”

「你**想喝點茶**嗎？」

****feel like doing something = 當下有做某事的意願、心情或慾望****

This does ****not**** mean “感覺像做某事”.

6. ****like + noun/person (喜歡) — 喜歡****

Now ****like**** functions as a verb.

Practice 12

> “I ****like**** her very much.”

「我很****喜歡****她。」

Practice 13

> “She ****likes**** tea.”

「她****喜歡****喝茶。」

****like someone/something = 對某人 / 某物有正面感受、喜愛或偏好****

This is a major separate lexical meaning from comparison ****like****.

7. ****like + -ing / to-infinitive (喜歡做某事) — 喜歡做.....****

Practice 14

> “She ****likes reading****.”

「她****喜歡閱讀****。」

Practice 15

> “I ****like to walk**** in the morning.”

「我****喜歡早上散步****。」

****like doing / like to do = 對某項活動有正面感受或偏好****

There can be subtle differences in context, but both are common.

8. **would like + noun (想要) — 想要 ; 希望得到**

A very important polite construction.

Practice 16

> “I’d **like** some tea.”

「我**想要**一些茶。」

Practice 17

> “Would you **like** some fruit?”

「你**想要 / 要不要**吃點水果？」

would like + noun = 比 want 更禮貌地表示想要某物

9. **would like to + verb (想做.....) — 想 ; 希望**

Practice 18

> “I’d **like to visit** her this weekend.”

「我這個週末**想去探望她**。」

Practice 19

> “She would **like to learn** another language.”

「她**想學**另一種語言。」

would like to do = 禮貌或較柔和地表示希望 / 想做某事

10. **like = enjoy / approve of (喜愛 / 認同) — 喜歡 ; 欣賞**

Practice 20

> “I **like** the way she treats people.”

「我很**欣賞 / 喜歡**她待人的方式。」

Practice 21

> “Do you **like** the new design?”

「你**喜歡**這個新設計嗎？」

like = 對某人、事物、方法或特質有正面評價

11. **like = want/prefer (非正式) — 想 ; 願意**

Mostly in certain constructions.

Practice 22

> “If you **like**, we can leave early.”

「如果你**願意 / 想的話**，我們可以提早離開。」

Practice 23

> “You can sit here if you **like**.”

「如果你**想的話**，可以坐這裡。」

if you like = 如果你願意 / 如果你想

This is not the ordinary “喜歡某物” sense.

12. **like = such as (例如) — 像.....這樣的 ; 例如**

A common example-giving use.

Practice 24

> “She enjoys quiet activities **like** reading and gardening.”

「她喜歡閱讀和園藝**之類的**安靜活動。」

Practice 25

> “Cities **like** Tokyo can be very busy.”

「**像東京這樣的**城市可能非常繁忙。」

like = 用來舉出屬於某類的例子；例如 / 像.....這樣的

13. **like** = approximately / around (大約；像是) — 大概；差不多

Informal.

Practice 26

> “There were **like** twenty people there.”

「那裡**大概有**二十個人。」

Practice 27

> “It took **like** an hour.”

「大概花了**一個小時左右**。」

like = 非正式口語中表示大約數量、時間或程度

Register:

> informal spoken English

14. **like** = discourse marker / filler (口語填充詞) — 就是；那個；怎麼說

Very common in informal spoken English.

Practice 28

> “I was, **like**, really surprised.”

「我當時，**就是 / 真的**，非常驚訝。」

Practice 29

> “She was **like**, ‘What are you doing?’”

「她當時就**說 / 反應是**：『你在做甚麼？』」

like = 口語中用來停頓、引出態度、模仿說話或表達反應的語篇標記

This is grammar/discourse polyfunctionality rather than core lexical polysemy.

15. **be like + quoted speech/reaction (口語) — 就說 / 當時反應是**

Practice 30

> “He was **like**, ‘No way.’”

「他當時就**說 / 反應是**：『不可能。』」

Practice 31

> “I was **like**, ‘Are you serious?’”

「我當時的反應就是：『你是認真的嗎？』」

be like + quotation = 非正式地引述某人說的話、反應或態度，不一定是逐字引用

16. **nothing like + noun (完全不像) — 一點也不像；完全不同**

Practice 32

> “The final result was **nothing like** what I expected.”

「最終結果跟我預期的**完全不同**。」

Practice 33

> “He is **nothing like** his brother.”

「他跟哥哥**一點也不像**。」

nothing like = 幾乎沒有相似之處

17. **nothing like + activity/thing (沒有甚麼比得上……) — 最好不過；沒有甚麼及得上**

A separate idiomatic branch.

Practice 34

> “There’s **nothing like** a hot cup of tea after a long day.”

「忙了一整天後，**沒有甚麼比一杯熱茶更舒服**。」

Practice 35

> “There’s **nothing like** spending time with family.”

「**沒有甚麼比陪伴家人更好**。」

there’s nothing like X = X 特別好、特別令人享受，其他東西難以相比

18. **something like + amount/description (大約 / 有點像) — 大約；類似**

Practice 36

> “It cost **something like** \$200.”

「它大概花了**二百元左右**。」

Practice 37

> “She gave me **something like** an apology.”

「她給了我一個**勉強算是道歉的表示**。」

something like = 大約 / 與某種描述相近但未必完全準確

19. **more like + correction (更像 / 應該說) — 更像是；應該說是**

Practice 38

> “It wasn’t a discussion; it was **more like** an argument.”

「那不是討論，**更像是一場爭吵**。」

Practice 39

> “Twenty minutes? **More like** an hour.”

「二十分鐘？**應該說差不多一個小時才對**。」

more like = 修正前面的描述，表示另一個說法更準確

20. **what is someone/something like?** (.....是怎樣的？) — 怎樣；甚麼樣

A crucial construction.

Practice 40

> “What is your grandmother **like**?”

「你的外婆**是怎樣的人**？」

Practice 41

> “What is the neighbourhood **like**?”

「那個社區**是怎樣的 / 環境如何**？」

what is X like? = 詢問某人 / 某事物的特質、性格、外觀或整體情況

Very important:

> “What does she like?”

> = 她喜歡甚麼？

versus:

> “What is she like?”

> = 她是怎樣的人？

21. **liking** = feeling of enjoyment/approval (喜愛) — 喜愛；好感

The main noun form.

Practice 42

> “She developed a **liking** for classical music.”

「她漸漸**喜歡上**古典音樂。」

Practice 43

> “I took an immediate **liking** to her.”

「我一開始便對她產生了**好感**。」

****liking = 對某人 / 某物產生的喜愛、偏好或好感****

22. ****take a liking to + person/thing — 開始喜歡；產生好感****

Practice 44

> “The child quickly ****took a liking to**** her.”

「那個孩子很快便**喜歡上她 / 對她有好感**。」

Practice 45

> “I’ve really ****taken a liking to**** this café.”

「我真的開始**很喜歡這間咖啡店**。」

****take a liking to = 開始對某人 / 某物產生喜愛或好感****

23. ****likeness = similarity (相似) — 相似；相像****

A useful noun extension.

Practice 46

> “There is a strong ****likeness**** between the two sisters.”

「兩姊妹之間非常**相像**。」

Practice 47

> “I can see the family ****likeness****.”

「我看得出他們的**家族相似特徵**。」

****likeness = 兩個人 / 事物之間的相似程度或相似之處****

24. ****likeness = image/representation of a person (肖像 / 形象) — 肖像 ; 形象****

A separate established noun sense.

Practice 48

> “The portrait captured her ****likeness****.”

「這幅肖像很好地捕捉了她的****相貌 / 形象****。」

Practice 49

> “The statue bears his ****likeness****.”

「這座雕像呈現出他的****外貌形象****。」

****likeness = 對某人的外貌所作的圖像、雕像或其他視覺再現****

25. ****alike = similar to each other (相似的) — 相像的 ; 相似地****

Practice 50

> “The two sisters look ****alike****.”

「兩姊妹長得很****相像****。」

Practice 51

> “The two situations are surprisingly ****alike****.”

「兩種情況出乎意料地****相似****。」

****alike = 兩個或以上的人 / 事物彼此相似****

Usually appears after the verb:

> They are alike.

Not normally:

> an alike person ❌

26. **unlike = different from (不像 ; 不同於) — 不像 ; 與.....不同**

Practice 52

> “She is **unlike** anyone else in the family.”

「她跟家裡其他人都**不太一樣**。」

Practice 53

> “**Unlike** his brother, he is very quiet.”

「**不像**他的哥哥，他非常安靜。」

unlike = 與某人 / 某事物在特徵或情況上不同

27. **unlike someone = uncharacteristic of someone (不像某人平常作風) — 不像.....平時會做的**

A useful evaluative construction.

Practice 54

> “It is **unlike her** to be late.”

「遲到**不像她平常的作風**。」

Practice 55

> “That comment was very **unlike him**.”

「那句話**很不像他平常會說的**。」

unlike someone = 某個行為與那個人平常的性格 / 習慣不一致

28. **likely = probable (很可能的) — 可能的 ; 很可能**

A related-looking form with its own developed modern meaning.

Practice 56

> “Rain is **likely** tomorrow.”

「明天**很可能**下雨。」

Practice 57

> “She is **likely to** arrive early.”

「她**很可能**會提早到達。」

likely = 根據現有情況，有相當大機會發生的

Important: in modern learner-facing curation, **likely** has developed far enough that it should be treated as a distinct family member, not simply “another meaning of like.”

29. **unlikely** = not probable (不太可能的) — 不太可能的

Practice 58

> “That outcome is **unlikely**.”

「那個結果**不太可能**發生。」

Practice 59

> “She is **unlikely to** change her mind.”

「她**不太可能**改變主意。」

unlikely = 發生機會較低的

30. **likelihood** = probability (可能性) — 可能性；機會

Practice 60

> “There is a high **likelihood** of rain.”

「下雨的**可能性很高**。」

Practice 61

> “The changes reduced the **likelihood** of error.”

「這些改變降低了出錯的**可能性**。」

likelihood = 某件事發生的可能程度 / 概率

31. **like-minded** = having similar opinions/interests (志同道合的) — 想法相近的 ; 志趣相投的

A useful compound.

Practice 62

> “She enjoys spending time with **like-minded** people.”

「她喜歡跟**志趣相投 / 想法相近的人**相處。」

Practice 63

> “The group brings together **like-minded** professionals.”

「這個組織把一群**理念相近的專業人士**聚集起來。」

like-minded = 在觀點、興趣、價值或態度上彼此相近的******

Important distinction: like = similar vs like = enjoy

This is the biggest contrast.

Comparison **like**

> “She is like an old tree.”

= 她像一棵老樹。

Verb **like**

> “I like old trees.”

= 我喜歡老樹。

Same spelling, completely different grammatical function and meaning.

Important distinction: **like vs as**

A classic learner distinction.

like + noun/pronoun

usually means:

> similar to

> “She is like her mother.”

as + role/function

means:

> in the role/capacity of

> “She works as a teacher.”

= 她以教師身份工作。

Compare:

> “He works like a teacher.”

= 他工作的方式像老師。

> “He works as a teacher.”

= 他的職業就是老師。

Important distinction: **like vs such as**

like

can introduce examples, often conversationally:

> “activities like reading and gardening”

such as

more explicitly means:

> examples including

> “activities such as reading and gardening”

Such as is often slightly more formal/precise.

Important distinction: **like vs similar to**

like

more natural and conversational:

> “This looks like mine.”

similar to

slightly more explicit/formal:

> “This design is similar to mine.”

Both express similarity.

Important distinction: **what is she like? vs what does she like?**

This is essential.

What is she like?

= What kind of person is she?

「她是怎樣的人？」

What does she like?

= What things does she enjoy?

「她喜歡甚麼？」

One small grammatical change produces a completely different question.

Important distinction: ****like doing vs would like to do****

****like doing****

= enjoy doing it generally

> “I like visiting my grandmother.”

= 我喜歡探望外婆。

****would like to do****

= want to do it now/in the future

> “I’d like to visit my grandmother.”

= 我想去探望外婆。

This is a crucial learner contrast.

Important distinction: ****feel like vs would like****

****feel like doing****

= be in the mood for doing it

> “I feel like going out.”

****would like to do****

= politely express desire/intention

> “I’d like to go out.”

The first emphasizes current mood; the second emphasizes desire.

Important distinction: **look like vs be like**

look like

= visual appearance

> “She looks like her mother.”

be like

= broader similarity in:

- * personality
- * behaviour
- * appearance
- * characteristics

> “She is like her mother.”

may mean more than physical appearance.

Important distinction: **sound like vs look like**

sound like

= similarity based on sound or description

look like

= similarity based on appearance

> “That sounds like a good idea.”

is about how the idea appears **from what is heard**, not how it physically looks.

Important distinction: **a bit like vs exactly like**

Your sentence uses:

> **a bit like**

This deliberately weakens the comparison.

a bit like

= similar in some ways

exactly like

= extremely similar / almost identical in relevant respects

So the metaphor is intentionally modest.

Important distinction: **like vs alike**

like

normally links two things:

> “She is like her mother.”

alike

usually comes after a linking verb:

> “She and her mother are alike.”

So:

> **A is like B**

versus:

> **A and B are alike**

Important distinction: **like vs unlike**

like

= similar to

unlike

= different from

> “Like her mother, she is patient.”

> “Unlike her brother, she is quiet.”

They form a useful contrast pair.

Important distinction: **like vs likely**

They look related but learners must separate them.

like

= similar to / enjoy

likely

= probable

> “She is likely to come.”

= 她很可能會來。

Not:

> “She is like to come.” ❌

Important distinction: **liking vs likeness**

liking

= feeling of enjoyment/preference

> “I developed a liking for tea.”

= 我漸漸喜歡上茶。

likeness

= similarity or visual representation

> “There is a strong likeness between them.”

= 他們很相像。

Completely different meanings.

Important distinction: **like** as filler vs lexical **like**

Informal spoken English often uses:

> “I was, like, really tired.”

Here **like** is not:

- * 喜歡
- * 相似

It functions as a **discourse filler/marker**.

This is useful for listening comprehension but should not be copied excessively into formal writing.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **like** family:

- * **be like** = 像 / 與.....相似
- * **a bit like** = 有點像
- * **look like** = 看起來像
- * **sound like** = 聽起來像
- * **feel like + noun** = 感覺像
- * **feel like + -ing** = 想做.....
- * **like — enjoy** = 喜歡
- * **like doing/to do** = 喜歡做.....
- * **would like + noun** = 想要
- * **would like to** = 想 / 希望做.....
- * **if you like** = 如果你願意 / 想
- * **like — such as** = 例如 / 像.....這樣的
- * **like — approximately** = 大約
- * **like — discourse marker** = 口語填充 / 引述反應
- * **nothing like** = 完全不像 / 沒有甚麼比得上
- * **something like** = 大約 / 類似
- * **more like** = 更像 / 應該說

* **what is X like?** = X 是怎樣的？
 * **liking** = 喜愛 / 好感
 * **take a liking to** = 開始喜歡
 * **likeness** = 相似 / 肖像
 * **alike** = 彼此相似
 * **unlike** = 不像 / 與.....不同
 * **likely** = 很可能的
 * **unlikely** = 不太可能的
 * **likelihood** = 可能性
 * **like-minded** = 志趣 / 想法相近的

As in the reference examples, **like** is a particularly rich case because it combines genuine lexical polysemy with grammatical multifunctionality and several useful family extensions. The mining manual specifically treats part-of-speech shifts and grammar-driven meaning changes as high-value candidates.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
like — similarity	表示兩個人 / 事物在某些特徵上相似但並非完全相同
be like	在特質、外觀、行為或感覺上與.....相似
look like	在外觀或視覺上與某人 / 某物相似
sound like	根據聲音或聽到的描述，覺得像某人 / 某物或符合某種情況
feel like + noun	主觀感受令人聯想到某人、某物或某種狀態
feel like + -ing	當下有做某件事的意願 / 心情
like — enjoy	對某人、某事物或活動有正面感受、喜愛或偏好
like doing/to do	喜歡並享受某項活動
would like + noun	以較禮貌方式表示想要某物
would like to	以較禮貌 / 柔和方式表示想做某事
if you like	如果你願意 / 想這樣做
like — example	引出同一類的例子；像.....這樣的 / 例如
like — approximate	非正式地表示大約的數量、時間或程度
like — discourse marker	口語中用來停頓、引出反應或模仿說話的語篇標記
be like + quotation	非正式地引述某人說話、反應或態度
nothing like — dissimilar	幾乎沒有相似之處；完全不像
there's nothing like	表示某事特別令人享受，沒有甚麼能比得上
something like	大約 / 與某種描述相近但不完全精確
more like	修正前述描述，表示另一個說法更準確
what is X like?	詢問某人 / 某物的性格、特質、外觀或整體情況
liking	對某人 / 某物產生的喜愛、偏好或好感
likeness — similarity	兩個人 / 事物之間的相似程度或相似特徵
likeness — representation	對某人外貌所作的圖像、雕像或其他視覺再現
alike	兩個或以上的人 / 事物彼此相似

unlike	與某人 / 某事物在特徵或情況上不同	
unlike someone — characteristic	某行為與該人平常性格或習慣不一致	
likely	根據現有情況有相當大機會發生的	
unlikely	發生機會較低的	
likelihood	某件事發生的可能程度 / 概率	
like-minded	在觀點、興趣、價值或態度上彼此相近的	

For your original sentence

> “She has a calm presence, and to me she is a bit ****like**** an old tree...”

The exact meaning is:

****like = 在某些特質或感覺上與另一事物相似****

Therefore:

> ****a bit like an old tree****

= ****「有點像一棵老樹 / 某些方面令人聯想到一棵老樹」****

Here ****like**** introduces a metaphorical comparison.

The grandmother and the tree share qualities such as:

- > stability
- > calmness
- > endurance
- > providing shade/support to others

So the central contrast is:

> ****She is like an old tree.****

> = 她像一棵老樹。

versus:

> ****She likes old trees.****

> = 她喜歡老樹。

Same spelling, but completely different grammatical functions and meanings.